FINAL PROJECT REPORT: DIGITAL LITERACY & CYBERSECURITY

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🎨 **Task 1: Digital Literacy Presentation**

Visual Reference: task-1-presentation/Digital literacy infographic.jpg

Description: The infographic was developed to provide a comprehensive roadmap for undergraduate students navigating the digital landscape. It focuses on four essential quadrants:

- **Useful Digital Tools:** Highlighting productivity suites (Google Workspace) and organization tools (Notion).
- **Safe Internet Practices:** Emphasizing the importance of strong passwords and phishing awareness.
- **Professional Presence:** Guidelines for building a credible online brand.
- **Email Etiquette:** Best practices for academic and professional correspondence.

Design Methodology: The layout utilizes a "Zero-Trust" visual theme, using clean blue gradients and distinct rounded panels to separate information clearly, ensuring high scannability for the reader.

💼 **Task 2: Professional Portfolio Development**

Platform Focus: GitHub, LinkedIn, Stack Overflow

Strategic Implementation: As an Integrated M.Tech student, my portfolio strategy centers on technical transparency.

- **GitHub:** Serves as the primary repository for my **Japanese Flashcard App** (Python) and **BGMI Tournament Manager** (C++).
- **LinkedIn:** Optimized to highlight my specialized degree at VIT Bhopal and connect with industry leaders at firms like **TechNova Solutions**.
- **Stack Overflow:** Used to document technical problem-solving and engage with the global developer community.

🌐 Task 3: Platform Engagement & Data Collection

Tools: HackerRank, Google Forms

Activity Proof:

- **HackerRank:** Documentation of consistent practice in algorithms and data structures to prepare for technical interviews.
- **Google Forms:** I developed a Digital Literacy Feedback Form to collect data on student awareness regarding cybersecurity.
- **Results:** Analysis of the FORM RESPONSE.png indicates that while students are familiar with basic tools, there is a significant gap in understanding UPI-specific fraud.

📧 Task 4: Professional Communication

Scenario Analysis: A critical failure in digital communication can lead to severe consequences, such as the **2018 Hawaii Missile Alert** panic. In an academic context, poor communication (like forgetting an attachment) can result in grade penalties.

Drafted Deliverables:

- **Extension Request:** A professional request for **MAT2001** (Calculus) regarding assignment deadlines.
- **Internship Inquiry:** A cold outreach email to **Ms. Sarah Jenkins** (TechNova Solutions).
- **Social Media Checklist:** 10 actionable Do's and Don'ts to maintain a clean digital footprint.

🛡️ Task 5: Cybercrime Case Study & Prevention

Focus: UPI/Online Payment Fraud

Case Study Summary: This section analyzes the "Collect Request" scam. Scammers exploit the psychological pressure of a "fast deal" on marketplaces to trick users into entering their UPI PIN. Since the PIN is only meant for *sending* money, victims inadvertently authorize the theft of their own funds.

Top Prevention Tips:

1. **UPI PIN Rule:** Never enter a PIN to receive money.

2. **Reporting:** Immediately report incidents to the **National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in)** or call **1930**.
3. **MFA:** Enable Multi-Factor Authentication on all core academic and financial accounts.

💡 Final Reflection

This project has significantly shifted my perspective on digital literacy. What surprised me most was the prevalence of social engineering; technical knowledge of Python or C++ is insufficient if one's "human firewall" is weak. Moving forward, I am adopting a **Zero-Trust policy** for all digital interactions—auditing permissions, using MFA, and verifying all financial requests—to ensure my professional journey at **VIT Bhopal** is secure and successful.